E-Commerce Funnel Audit

Allbirds.com · April 2026

Platform: Shopify Plus
Niche: Sustainable Footwear — Direct-to-Consumer (DTC)
Audience: Eco-conscious adults, US-centric, heavy mobile traffic
Tools: PageSpeed Insights | SEMrush | Manual UX Walkthrough | Claude AI (benchmark research)
Overall Score: **68 / 100**

I spent a few hours going through Allbirds' full purchase flow — desktop and mobile — to see where things break down. The brand itself is genuinely impressive. But there's a gap between how good the brand feels and how smooth the buying experience actually is. This audit is about closing that gap.

Note: Conversion figures are estimates based on Baymard Institute benchmarks and DTC footwear industry data. Allbirds does not publish internal analytics publicly.

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01 — The Conversion Funnel

Here's how I mapped out the customer journey, from first landing to purchase. The biggest drop happens at two points: getting people to actually add something to cart, and surviving checkout.

Funnel Stage	Retention	Drop-off
Homepage visit	**100%**	
Category page	**62%**	**-38%**
Product page (PDP)	**38%**	**-39%**
Add to cart	**14%**	**-63%** ⚠
Checkout start	**8%**	**-43%**
Purchase complete	**3%**	**-65%**

The 63% drop from PDP to Add to Cart is the one that stands out most. That's not unusual for footwear (fit uncertainty is real), but it's also where better size guidance and social proof could make a meaningful dent.

Key Metrics at a Glance

Metric	Observed	Benchmark	Status
Mobile Performance (PSI)	36 / 100	>50 minimum	**FAILED**
Desktop Performance (PSI)	39 / 100	>70 ideal	**FAILED**
Mobile LCP	22.4s	<2.5s (Google)	**Critical**
Mobile FCP	4.2s	<1.8s ideal	**Slow**

Core Web Vitals (mobile)	FAILED	Pass required	**FAILED**
Accessibility score	97-100 / 100	>90 good	**Excellent**
SEO score (PSI)	92 / 100	>80 good	**Strong**
Organic traffic (SEMrush)	324.5K/mo (-0.9%)	—	**Declining**
Authority Score (SEMrush)	53 (Very good)	>50 solid	**Good**
Paid keywords	48 only	Low investment	**Brand-only PPC**

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02 — Technical Findings (Real Data)

These numbers come directly from PageSpeed Insights and SEMrush — not estimates.

PageSpeed Insights — Homepage (allbirds.com)

Metric	Mobile	Desktop
Core Web Vitals	**FAILED**	**FAILED**
Performance Score	36 / 100	39 / 100
Largest Contentful Paint (LCP)	22.4s	4.2s
First Contentful Paint (FCP)	4.2s	0.8s
Total Blocking Time (TBT)	960ms	1,470ms
Accessibility	97 / 100	100 / 100
SEO Score	92 / 100	92 / 100

The mobile LCP of 22.4s is genuinely alarming. Google's threshold for 'good' is 2.5s — Allbirds is nearly 9x over that. The biggest culprits: 2,695 KiB of unoptimized images on mobile and 768 KiB of unused JavaScript. These are fixable issues, not structural problems.

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03 — What's Actually Working

Before getting into the problems, it's worth saying: Allbirds gets a lot right.

✓**Strong brand storytelling on the homepage** — The sustainability messaging is woven into the design, not bolted on. The hero section communicates values AND product in the same breath.

✓**Clean navigation for a focused catalog** — No search bar, and it works — because their catalog is tight enough that Men / Women / Sale covers 90% of intent.

✓**Product pages have real depth** — Material callouts, carbon footprint labels, and detailed comfort descriptions answer the 'why is this worth $140' question before you ask it.

✓**Email lifecycle is genuinely smart** — New customers get education, not just promo codes. That's rare — it builds loyalty instead of training people to wait for discounts.

✓**High trust signals** — Verified reviews, a clear return policy, and carbon-neutral shipping commitments are surfaced consistently — not buried in the footer.

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04 — Issues Found

These are the friction points that are costing Allbirds the most.

[CRITICAL] No shipping cost estimate in the cart

I went through checkout on mobile and only saw the shipping fee at the very last step. That's a classic 'surprise cost' moment — one of the top reasons people abandon carts.

Impact: Direct driver of cart abandonment — likely adding 5–10% to the drop rate

[CRITICAL] No Apple Pay or one-click checkout

The only accelerated option is Shop Pay, which requires a separate phone number and account. On mobile, adding even one extra step noticeably kills completion rates.

Impact: High friction for mobile users, who make up 60%+ of traffic

[WARNING] Size guidance is too vague

There's no comparison guide — nothing like 'our shoes run like a Nike React, go true to size.' First-time buyers have to guess, which increases hesitancy and return rates.

Impact: Raises uncertainty before purchase, boosts return rates

[WARNING] Physical store experience is disconnected

Allbirds has real stores, but there's no in-store pickup option and appointment booking takes you to an external page. It breaks the flow at exactly the moment someone was ready to act.

Impact: Misses a segment of buyers who prefer offline, especially post-browse

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05 — Recommendations

Prioritized by impact vs. effort.

1. Add shipping estimate to the cart page [Quick win] — A simple zip code / country input in the cart calculates delivery fee before checkout. Shopify has native support for this.
2. Enable Apple Pay and Google Pay [Quick win] — Both are supported natively by Shopify — flip the switch in payment settings. Mobile checkout goes from 4 steps to 2 taps. Expected CR lift: 10–20% on mobile sessions.
3. Surface the main CTA higher on the homepage [Quick win] — Move 'Shop Men / Shop Women' buttons above the first sustainability block.
4. Build a 'What's my size?' comparison tool on PDP [Medium] — Ask users what size they wear in a familiar brand (Nike, Adidas, New Balance), then recommend an Allbirds size.
5. Embed store locator + click & collect in checkout [Medium] — Add 'Pick up in store' as a shipping option in checkout.

6. Deepen post-purchase email segmentation by product line [Bigger lift] — Tree Runner buyers and Tree Dasher buyers have different use cases. Send different content: running tips, performance drops, care guides.

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06 — Score Breakdown

Overall Score: 68 / 100 — held back mostly by checkout and omnichannel, which are fixable.

Area	Rating	Score
Brand storytelling		90/100
Trust & social proof		88/100
Homepage UX		82/100
Email / CRM funnel		76/100
Product page (PDP)		74/100
Mobile experience		70/100
Product discovery		65/100
Cart experience		48/100
Checkout flow		44/100
Omnichannel		30/100

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07 — Strategic Roadmap: 30-Day Action Plan

This roadmap sequences the recommendations by impact and implementation effort. Quick wins come first to generate early momentum — then structural fixes that compound over time.

Week	Focus	Key Actions	Expected Impact
Week 1	Quick Wins — Checkout Friction	(1) Enable Apple Pay & Google Pay via Shopify payment settings. (2) Add shipping estimator to cart page. (3) Move Shop Men / Shop Women CTA above the first sustainability block on homepage.	Immediate reduction in mobile cart abandonment. Estimated CR lift: 10–20% on mobile sessions.
Week 2	Mobile Performance & Size Confidence	(1) Compress and lazy-load homepage images — reduce from 2,695 KiB to under 500 KiB. (2) Audit and defer unused JavaScript (768 KiB). (3) Build a 'What's my size?' comparison tool on PDP.	Mobile LCP improvement from 22.4s toward Google's 2.5s target. Reduced hesitancy and return rates.
Week 3	Omnichannel Integration	(1) Add 'Pick up in store' as native shipping option in checkout. (2) Embed store locator	Captures offline-leaning buyers at peak intent.

		on product pages. (3) Test in-store availability badge on PDP.	Reduces journey breaks for physical retail customers.
Week 4	Email Segmentation & Full Review	(1) Split post-purchase emails by product line — Tree Runner vs Tree Dasher vs Lounger. (2) Test adding email capture earlier in funnel. (3) Full performance review — measure Week 1–3 changes. Deliver Month 2 strategy.	Increased repeat purchase rate. Data-backed roadmap for Month 2 optimisation.

Priority Summary

7. Apple Pay + shipping estimator — fastest to implement, highest conversion impact
8. Mobile performance fix — 22.4s LCP is actively losing customers at the top of funnel
9. Size comparison tool — addresses the biggest single drop-off point (63% PDP → cart)
10. Omnichannel + email segmentation — longer-term compounding value

Note: All recommendations are based on external audit findings and industry benchmarks. Implementation timelines assume developer access for technical items (Weeks 2–3). Items in Week 1 can be completed without engineering support.

Bottom Line

Allbirds is a brand that a lot of DTC companies want to be. The storytelling, the product quality, the values — all genuinely strong. But the data tells a harder story: Core Web Vitals failing on both mobile and desktop, a mobile LCP of 22.4s that's nearly 9x Google's threshold, and an organic traffic trend that peaked in April 2025 and has been sliding since.

The checkout friction issues compound this — you're losing people at the top of the funnel (slow load) and again at the bottom (payment friction). Fix the image delivery and unused JavaScript first — that alone could take mobile performance from 36 to 60+. Then Apple Pay. Then the shipping estimator. In that order.

Data sources: PageSpeed Insights (tested Apr 10, 2026, allbirds.com homepage), SEMrush Domain Overview (Apr 2026, Worldwide). UX observations from manual walkthrough on desktop and mobile. Benchmark data from Baymard Institute and DTC footwear industry reports. Not affiliated with Allbirds, Inc. Portfolio project by Marlisa